The Wilmot Proviso

Rep. David Wilmot · August 8, 1846

Source: Wilmot Proviso, amendment to an appropriations bill (1846), Congressional Globe. Public domain. Complete text.

> Attached to a war-funding bill, this short proviso would have banned slavery from any land won from Mexico. Though it never became law, it inflamed the sectional crisis and helped give rise to the antislavery Republican Party.

COMPLETE TEXT — UNEDITED

Provided, That, as an express and fundamental condition to the acquisition of any territory from the Republic of Mexico by the United States, by virtue of any treaty which may be negotiated between them, and to the use by the Executive of the moneys herein appropriated, neither slavery nor involuntary servitude shall ever exist in any part of said territory, except for crime, whereof the party shall first be duly convicted.